SIG Handbook

Edinburgh University CompSoc
c/o Edinburgh University Students Association
5/2 Bristo Square Potterrow
Edinburgh
EH8 9AL

PUBLIC

2026-10-18

Contents

1 Foreword 1
1.1 Formalisation of Terms 1
2 Committee 1
3 Activities, Events, and Responsabilities 2
4 Finance 2
5 Interraction With CompSoc 2
6 Inactivity 3

1 Foreword

This handbook contains a list of regulations, split into three different levels, which aims to guide Special Interest Groups (SIGs, a.k.a. Sub-committees in EUSA regulation) through daily and yearly operation. The goal of this regulation is for SIGs to primarily manage themselves. In almost all cases CompSoc should not and should have no reason to be involved in the day-to-day running of a SIG. To that end, this document is created.

There are two major changes in this document which should be reviewed first, the inactivity proceedings which formalise actions CompSoc may take, and the addition of SIG mandates.

Thank you to all involved in keeping our SIGs best-in-class, you make CompSoc great.

Thank you to Marton, the author of the SIG handbook before the 2026 rewrite, who large portions of this document have been mercilessly copied from.

CompSoc <3 you, from Skye, Emily, and all editors who may follow (add your names).

1.1 Formalisation of Terms

1.1.1 "is" and "must" is a requirement, "should" is an ideal situation that should be aimed for, "may" is a choice a committee has avaliable to them but not a requirement.

1.1.2 A "hard majority" is a vote in favour by equal or greater to two thirds of total committee, a "soft majority" is greater than half of committee at a meeting.

2 Committee

2.1 All SIG committee members must uphold the SIGs primary objective to provide benefit to CompSoc members and the world at large.

2.2 A committee must be made up by at minimum one president and two additional members to act as "watchdogs" so no committee operates without the possiblity of voting against the president.

2.3 Presidents and all committee must remember that everyone involved in running a SIG is a volunteer, and do all possible to reduce stress and friction within a SIG.

2.4 A committee should be made up of an odd amount of members to avoid a voting tie

2.5 The president is responsible for the management and operations of the SIG, and may delegate tasks as seen fit.

2.6 A committee may defer a decision to CompSoc if they are unable to reach a decision, however a limit may be put on this if it is overused.

2.7 If a disagreement about leadership arises, a SIG may request CompSoc Vice President (who may delegate this task to a chosen representitive also on CompSoc committee) to assist in resolving the issue and/or mediate in any discussion.

3 Activities, Events, and Responsabilities

3.1 SIGs must run at minimum one activity per month to be considered active, for example pub nights, weekly meetings, or talks.

3.2 SIGs may also run non-regular larger events, for example conferences.

3.3 SIGs are responsible for making their events and services as accessable as possible, and the CompSoc EDI Rep is availiable to provide assistance or guidance.

3.4 SIGs are responsible for renewal, and

4 Finance

4.1 A SIG must use the CompSoc bank account, however they may apply for an exemption in order to hold their own bank account, which will have to be approved by a soft majority of CompSoc committee.

4.2 If this exemption is granted - for the purpose of tranparency and overwatch - a SIG must provide bank statements to CompSoc committee if requested, and this exemption may be revoked at any time by a hard majority vote of CompSoc committee. Tardis receives this automatically upon the first introduction of this document.

4.3 SIGs may seek their own sponsors, and any funds received will be allocated to that SIG barring any other extenuating circumstances.

4.4 Funds raised by SIGs through sponsorships, event ticket sales, or other means will be allocated to the SIG and can be spent at the SIG's discretion.

4.5 SIGs can request additional funding from CompSoc for relevant events and activities on top of sponsorship funding that they have secured.

4.6 A SIG should seek prior approval and make appropriate notification before contacting, seeking out, or aquiring a sponsor another SIG or CompSoc is already sponsored by. This is to prevent sponsor poaching.

4.7 A SIG may not charge their members money for access to regular services or activities, however major events may be charged for and ticketed, as long as attendance isn't required for participation in the SIG.

5 Interraction With CompSoc

5.1 The president should attend CompSoc committee meetings and excercise their voice representing their SIG members as they see fit. If a SIG president is unable to go to a meeting they may designate another member of the SIG committee.

5.2 SIGs may vote in CompSoc general committee meetings, in which case a SIG posesses one vote regardless of the amount of members present. The SIG must have a representitive present to vote, although an exception may be made if a SIGs representitive has made a sufficient effort to make committee aware they'd like to vote online.

5.3 SIGs must make their affiliation with CompSoc as a Special Interest Group obvious on their website and communication channels.

5.4 Sigs may use CompSoc channels to promote their events in addition to their own channel unless otherwise restricted, and abiding by any rate limits.

5.5 SIGs may request the CompSoc TechSec bridge the general and announcement channels of their SIG discord servers to a dedicated channel in the CompSoc discord server.

5.6 SIGs may request support and guidance from the CompSoc graphic designer in relation to branding and promotional material.

5.7 SIGs may have an event featured on the CompSoc newsletter or announcement channel. If they would like this they must make the CompSoc secretary aware at least 72 hours in advance.

6 Inactivity

6.1 Inactivity is a natural state for a SIG which has reached the end of its life. If a SIG becomes inactive by abandonment, it should be allowed to die, but CompSoc must do its best to preserve documentation in case it is ever to be restarted, and for its historical significance. Forms of natural inactivity are as follows:

- Functional Inactivity
  - 6.1.1 A SIG has failed its duties to run events as outlined in this document, specifically by abandonment. At this point CompSoc committee may by hard majority vote choose to place the SIG into inactivity.
  - 6.1.2 The inactivity period for this case is 3 months at which point the SIG is considered dead.
  - 6.1.3 In this case, anyone is free to take control of the SIG by having a request approved by CompSoc committee. This can be done during the proceedings or after the SIG has died, at which point it is revived.
  - 6.1.4 If it is being revived, an EGM must be called if any additional members are needed to reach a minimum. The exact revival proceedings are decided by CompSoc committee.
- Failiure to continue government
  - 6.1.5 A SIG has failed to elect a new committee or all of committee has quit, therefore no one is left to run an EGM. At this point CompSoc committee must take over control and run an EGM at earliest convenience, or may vote by hard majority to enter the inactivity period.
  - 6.1.6 The inactivity period for this case is 3 months at which point the SIG is considered dead.
  - 6.1.7 As above, anyone may by approved request to CompSoc revivte the SIG, and must call an EGM if needed.

6.2 If a SIG is forcefully placed into inactivity CompSoc must aim to resolve any issues as fast as possible and get the SIG back on its feet, prioritising the SIGs and CompSocs members' interests. Forms of unnatural inactivity are as follows:

- Administrative Inactivity
  - 6.2.1 A SIG has done something bad enough that its freedoms must be restricted until the situation is resolved. Possible examples are:
    - A new rule must be added to ban a previously legal action which was bad enough for CompSoc to deem a rule must be added against it, at which point a SIGs operations may be frozen until the new rule is added to prevent further harm.
    - A SIG fails repeatedly to follow rules or the EUSA code of conduct, prioritize the needs of its members, a vote of no confidence is filed agains committee, or the SIG has put someone in danger, at which point CompSoc deems it appropriate to replace the SIGs committee, freezing its operations until an EGM is run.
    - A SIG has to be given a time limit to resolve issues, at which point the inactivity time limit can be applied to give them a deadline before they are forcefully dissolved.

6.2.2 This form of inactivity must be activated by a hard majority CompSoc committee vote, and further major actions after that must pass a soft majority vote.

6.2.3 There is no set time limit to this form of inactivity, as it exists for emergencies only and may be adapted as the situation sees fit.

6.2.4 This system is an aboslute last resort, and should never be used.

6.3 This is the only mechanism by which CompSoc should forcefully interfere with a SIGs operations.

6.4 Inactivity proceedings allow CompSoc to gain control over the committees bank accounts and other assets - which must be provided at request.